

End of Legend?

Within months of release HTC plans to discontinue the Legend as it cannot accumulate enough resources to mass produce the phone especially its screen

What an idea!

People in India don't seem to be excited about the possibility of financial transactions over a mobile phone. What different are you doing for spreading awareness on this?

It is a misconception that Indians aren't excited about mobile payments. We have launched a pilot in Pune this year and the response was overwhelming. People from all age-groups are welcoming the concept of mobile payments as it makes their life easier. Increasingly with increasing mobile phone penetration, people are getting technology savvy and can maneuver their way easily.

Also technology providers should understand that their applications should be easy and not complicated. The more the number of complications, lesser will be the popularity of the service. It has been a comparatively easy job in spreading the awareness on mobile payments. RBI has been very encouraging and so have been the banks. In Pune to increase awareness of mobile payments, we have tied-up with almost 200 merchants and 49 utility billers. Hence these tie-ups help us in propagating our service.

How different is your product than similar ideas in the past that were launched?

Unlike all mobile payment platforms, Obopay's platform is universal in nature. It is platform agnostic and hence can work on any mobile handset, service provider and financial institution. It works on all forms including SMS IVR, External Application download and Mobile Web Browser. The Obopay application can be downloaded on an ultra low cost handset and can also be accessed via the internet for high-end phones. Hence the type of phone / service provider or the financial institution is not a barrier.

Comment on the security aspect of mobile transactions. What are the implications of losing your cellphone that is linked to your bank account? How are your customers safe?

Obopay takes the security of each account holder very seriously. All Obopay accounts are protected against unauthorized transactions and use advanced encrypted security technology whenever possible to prevent unauthorized access to account holder data. Also the process is secured via 2-Factor authentication and hence every account holder has to log-in with a password which will be authenticated by the technology present at the back-end.

When using the Obopay India service, protection against unauthorized use is provided through PIN-based authentication. Users must enter the PIN when sending or requesting money using Obopay India service from their mobile phones.

Additionally, all data transmitted via the Obopay India service is protected by advanced security technology against unauthorized access. To provide this level of security, Obopay India uses multiple layers of advanced encryption algorithms so that transmitted data cannot be intercepted or compromised. Encryption technology is used for securing transactions between the mobile application and a user's bank account and for securing data transmissions over the cellular network.

Thus, the chances of theft are almost nil. Basis these procedures, the only lag would be consumers end and even the



In our Independence special, we pondered on the possibility of mobile transactions. We believe this could help us solve the biggest threat our nation faces – corruption, by way of eliminating the need to transact in currency notes. We spoke to Deepak Chandnani, President, Obopay – one such company that holds promise to our dream!

chances for that would be minimum.

We have taken the responsibility of educating people on how to use Obopay to reduce any mistakes in transactions and have tried to keep the software as simple as possible.

There was a commercial of a popular mobile service provider that promoted the idea of vegetable vendors being paid by way of an SMS. Is India prepared for the idea?

Yes definitely. In fact one of the ways people can transact is by using SMS. This is the simpler way and applications using SMS can work on low-end phones as well. It will also be more popular since not many Indians are connected to the internet and might not know the way to transact using a mobile web browser. **d**